Unicellular organisms

Some living things are tiny and made up of only one cell. A living thing that is made of only one cell is classified as a unicellular organism. One type of unicellular organism is an **amoeba**. **Bacteria** are also made of only a single cell.

Unicellular organisms are very tiny and most cannot be seen without a microscope. We call them **microorganisms**.

☞ **1** Fill in the blanks with the correct word from the word bank.

	Word bank
Unicellular organisms are found all over Earth – from the top of mountains to the ocean floor to inside human _____. Some require _____, some do not. Some get food from their _____ and some produce their own food.	oxygen bodies environment
Microorganisms multiply quickly. They usually live in environments that are _____, moist, dark and have plant or _____ material in them. Rubbish bins, compost heaps, _____, clothing and even bedding contain microorganisms.	ponds animal warm
Bacteria and _____ are usually microorganisms. Some types of algae (rootless water plants) and fungi (moulds and yeasts) are _____ too.	amoebae microorganisms
Microorganisms can be _____ or removed with chemicals and are unable to survive in sterile, _____ environments.	clean killed

2 What do you think the prefix 'uni-' means?

_____

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3 What do you think the prefix 'micro-' means?

_____

4 Are the following words plural or singular?

a) bacteria _____

b) amoeba _____

c) bacterium _____

d) amoebae _____

5 Circle the correctly spelled word in each set of words.

a)	animal	aminal	animel
b)	ameba	amoba	amoeba
c)	bateria	bacteria	bacterea
d)	microrganisms	micorganisms	microorganisms
e)	microscope	micrascope	microsope

6 Which of the following environments might contain a lot of live microorganisms? Circle two choices in each set.

a)	compost bin	garbage bin	new stainless steel bin
b)	backyard pond	natural lake	chlorinated swimming pool
c)	a sterile surgeon's glove	a gardening glove	old woollen gloves

7 Are the following statements true or false?

a)	Unicellular organisms are found all over the world.	True	False
b)	All unicellular organisms need oxygen to live.	True	False
c)	Unicellular organisms are large and easy to see.	True	False

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